



Complete Setup & Usage Guide

A free, open-source Grammarly alternative and AI commit-message assistant, powered by Google Gemini — \$0 cost, no subscription.

Covers three components:

Component	Platform	Trigger
Browser Extension	Chrome / Edge	Right-click selected text
Desktop App	Windows (any app)	Global hotkey (Ctrl+Alt+R, etc.)
Git Commit Tool	Any OS, any repo	Run 'ai-commit' after git add

Prepared for Somil Merugawar | MIT License

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1. Overview — What This Project Is

Grammarly is a great product, but it's a paid subscription for most useful features. This project does the same core job — select text, get it corrected or rewritten — for \$0, using Google Gemini's free API tier (no credit card required). It also includes a bonus tool for generating git commit messages from your staged code changes.

Component	Works In	How You Trigger It	Best For
Browser Extension	Any website (Gmail, Docs, Twitter)	Right-click selected text	Browser-only workflows
Desktop App	Any Windows app (Notepad, Word, WhatsApp)	Global hotkey (Ctrl+Alt+R, etc.)	System-wide use
Git Commit Tool	Any git repo, any OS	Run 'ai-commit' after git add	Better commit messages

Rewrite modes available in both the browser extension and desktop app:

- **Fix Grammar & Spelling** — corrects errors, keeps your voice
- **Improve Writing** — clarity and flow, same meaning
- **Make Formal** — professional tone for work
- **Make Casual** — friendly, conversational tone
- **Make Shorter** — trims to the essential point

Privacy:

All text is sent directly to Google's Gemini API over HTTPS and nowhere else. Nothing is logged or stored by a third party — there is no server in the middle; this is a fully client-side tool using your own API key.

2. Part A — Browser Extension Setup

Works in Chrome and Edge. Estimated setup time: 2 minutes.

Step 1 — Get a free Gemini API key

1. Go to aistudio.google.com/apikey
2. Sign in with any Google account
3. Click **Create API key** — no credit card needed
4. Copy the key (starts with 'Alza...')

Step 2 — Install the extension

5. Download/clone the project repo and locate the 'browser-extension' folder
6. Open **chrome://extensions** (or **edge://extensions** in Edge)
7. Turn on **Developer mode** (top-right toggle)
8. Click **Load unpacked** → select the 'browser-extension' folder
9. Click the new extension icon in your toolbar → paste your Gemini API key → **Save**

Important:

Keep the 'browser-extension' folder where it is after loading it — Chrome reads the extension live from that folder. Moving or deleting it will break the extension.

3. Part A — Browser Extension Usage

10. Select any text in a text box, email, doc, or webpage
11. Right-click → **AI Rewrite** → pick a mode
12. Wait 1–2 seconds — the selected text is replaced automatically

Menu Option	What It Does
Fix Grammar & Spelling	Corrects errors, keeps tone and length
Improve Writing	Better clarity and flow, same meaning
Make Formal / Professional	Business-appropriate tone
Make Casual / Friendly	Conversational tone
Make Shorter	Trims to the essential point

Notes and limits

- Works in normal text boxes and in 'contenteditable' areas (Gmail, Docs, most modern editors)
- **Does NOT work inside Notepad, Word desktop app, or other non-browser apps** — browser extensions can only see inside the browser. Use the Desktop App (Part B) for that.
- Your API key is stored locally in Chrome's synced storage, never sent anywhere except directly to Google's Gemini API
- Cost: \$0 — Gemini's free tier covers roughly 1,500 requests/day, far more than typical personal use

4. Part B — Desktop App (AutoHotkey) Setup

Works system-wide on Windows: Notepad, WhatsApp Desktop, Word, Outlook, Telegram, Discord, browsers — anywhere you can select and paste text. Built with AutoHotkey v2 because it's purpose-built for reliable global hotkeys and simulated keystrokes on Windows.

Step 1 — Install AutoHotkey v2

13. Go to autohotkey.com
14. Click **Download** — this installs the latest v2 by default
15. Run the installer, accept defaults

Step 2 — Get a free Gemini API key

Same key works across all three tools — see Section 10 if you don't have one yet.

Step 3 — Run it

16. Locate the 'desktop-autohotkey' folder from the project repo
17. Double-click **AI_Rewrite.ahk**
18. A setup window asks for your Gemini API key — paste it, click **Save & Start**
19. A small icon appears in your system tray (bottom-right, near the clock)

Optional — compile to a standalone .exe

20. Right-click **AI_Rewrite.ahk** → **Compile Script** (added automatically by the AutoHotkey installer)
21. This produces **AI_Rewrite.exe** in the same folder
22. Double-click that exe directly — no .ahk file or script editor needed afterward

Optional — run automatically on startup

23. Press Win+R, type `shell:startup`, press Enter
24. Copy **AI_Rewrite.ahk** (or the compiled .exe) into the folder that opens
25. It now launches automatically every time you log into Windows

5. Part B — Desktop App Usage

Select text in any application, then press:

Hotkey	Action
Ctrl + Alt + R	Fix Grammar & Spelling
Ctrl + Alt + I	Improve Writing
Ctrl + Alt + F	Make Formal / Professional
Ctrl + Alt + C	Make Casual / Friendly
Ctrl + Alt + S	Make Shorter

A small notification popup (bottom-right) confirms each step — copying, sending, done — so you can see exactly what's happening.

Updating your API key later

Right-click the tray icon → **Update API Key**.

Stopping it

Right-click the tray icon → **Quit**.

6. Part B — Common Issues We Actually Hit (and Fixes)

These are documented from real setup problems encountered while building this tool — if something isn't working, check here first.

Issue: Nothing happens when the hotkey is pressed, no error at all

Cause: Global hotkeys and simulated keystrokes need Administrator rights on Windows. Without elevation, hotkeys silently do nothing.

Fix: Right-click AI_Rewrite.ahk (or the compiled .exe) → Run as administrator. If a target app (e.g. an app you're testing in) runs elevated but AI Rewrite doesn't, Windows blocks the simulated keystrokes from reaching it — both need matching privilege levels.

Issue: 'No text selected' even though text is clearly highlighted

Cause: The simulated Ctrl+C fired while the hotkey's own modifier keys (Ctrl/Alt) were still logically 'held' by the OS, corrupting the simulated combo.

Fix: Confirm the target application (e.g. Notepad) was the focused, front-most window at the exact moment you pressed the hotkey — not a browser tab or another app. Also confirm the text is actually selected (blue-highlighted), not just clicked into.

Issue: 'python is not recognized' (only relevant if using the older Python build)

Cause: Python wasn't added to the system PATH during install.

Fix: Reinstall Python from python.org and check 'Add Python to PATH' on the first install screen before clicking Install.

Issue: API error notification appears

Cause: Either an invalid/expired API key, or you've hit Gemini's free daily limit.

Fix: Right-click tray icon → Update API Key to re-enter it. If the key is correct, wait — Gemini's free tier resets every 24 hours.

7. Part C — Git Commit Tool Setup

Analyzes your staged git changes and suggests a Conventional Commits message. Works on any OS (Windows, Mac, Linux) inside any git repository.

Requirements

- Python 3.8+
- Git
- A free Gemini API key (Section 10)

Step 1 — Install the dependency

```
pip install requests
```

Step 2 — Place the script somewhere permanent

Not inside any single project — put it somewhere central so it works across every repo on your machine, e.g.:

```
Windows:      C:\Users\YourName\tools\ai_commit.py  
macOS/Linux: ~/tools/ai_commit.py
```

Step 3 — Set your API key once, globally

macOS / Linux — add to ~/.bashrc or ~/.zshrc:

```
export GEMINI_API_KEY="your-key-here"
```

Then run:

```
source ~/.bashrc
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
setx GEMINI_API_KEY "your-key-here"
```

Then restart your terminal for it to take effect.

Alternative:

If you skip this step, the script will simply ask for your key the first time you run it and save it to ~/.ai-commit/config.ini automatically — global env var setup is optional convenience, not required.

8. Part C — Git Commit Tool Usage

From inside any git repository with staged changes:

```
git add <files>
python ai_commit.py
```

The tool shows your staged files, generates a Conventional Commits message, then gives you options:

Key	Action
Enter	Commit immediately with the suggested message
e	Edit the message yourself before committing
r	Ask Gemini to regenerate the suggestion
q	Cancel — nothing is committed

Example output

```
Staged changes:
math_utils.py | 6 ++++++
1 file changed, 6 insertions(+)

Analyzing diff and generating commit message...

-----
Suggested commit message:
-----
feat(math_utils): add subtract and multiply functions

- Extends existing add() with subtract() and multiply()
- No changes to existing function signatures
-----

[Enter] commit as-is  [e] edit  [r] regenerate  [q] cancel:
```

Tip:

When editing (option 'e'), you can type multiple lines including blank lines between a summary and bullet points. Press Enter twice in a row (two blank lines) to finish and submit your edited message.

9. Part C — Making 'ai-commit' Work in Any Repo

Instead of typing the full Python path every time, set up a short command that works from any git repository on your machine.

macOS / Linux

Add this alias to ~/.bashrc or ~/.zshrc:

```
alias ai-commit="python3 ~/tools/ai_commit.py"
```

Windows

Create a file named ai-commit.bat containing:

```
@echo off
python "C:\Users\YourName\tools\ai_commit.py" %*
```

26. Add the folder containing that .bat file to your Windows PATH:
27. Press Windows key → type 'environment variables' → open 'Edit the system environment variables'
28. Click **Environment Variables** → under 'User variables', select **Path** → **Edit**
29. Click **New** → paste the folder path containing ai-commit.bat
30. Click OK on all windows to save
31. **Close and reopen PowerShell** — PATH changes don't apply to already-open windows

From then on, in any repo:

```
cd any-project-folder
git add .
ai-commit
```

Note:

This tool is completely independent from the Desktop App (Part B) — they don't share a process, hotkey, or config file, and running one has zero impact on the other. Both may draw from the same Gemini free daily quota if used heavily on the same day, but that's rarely a concern for normal personal use.

10. Getting a Free Gemini API Key

All three components use the same free Gemini API key — get one once, reuse it everywhere.

32. Go to aistudio.google.com/apikey
33. Sign in with any Google account
34. Click **Create API key**
35. No credit card, no billing setup, no payment page — this is genuinely free
36. Copy the key (starts with 'Alza...') and paste it wherever a tool asks for it

Free tier limits:

Google's Gemini free tier covers roughly 1,500 requests/day on Flash models — far more than typical personal use across all three tools combined.

Common confusion:

This is a separate system from any paid AI chat subscription you may already have (e.g. ChatGPT Plus, Claude Pro). Those subscriptions do not include API credits — API access is billed and provisioned completely separately, and Gemini's free tier sidesteps that entirely.

11. FAQ

Q: Is this really free?

Yes. Google's Gemini API free tier covers generous daily usage with no credit card required. You provide your own key.

Q: Why isn't there a right-click menu in the desktop version?

Windows doesn't allow third-party apps to add entries into other apps' native right-click menus (Notepad's, Word's, etc.) — that's an OS-level restriction, not a limitation of this tool. A global hotkey is the standard, reliable workaround.

Q: Does this work on Mac or Linux?

The browser extension works on any OS Chrome/Edge supports. The desktop app (Part B) currently targets Windows only, since AutoHotkey is Windows-native. The git commit tool (Part C) works on any OS.

Q: Is my API key safe?

It's stored locally on your machine — in Chrome's synced storage for the extension, a local config.ini for the desktop app, or an environment variable / local config file for the commit tool — and only ever sent to Google's Gemini API. There is no server of ours in the middle.

Q: Will running the commit tool affect my running desktop rewrite app?

No. They are completely independent programs with separate processes and separate configuration files. Starting, stopping, or using one has no effect on the other.

Q: Do I need to reinstall dependencies after a code update?

Only if the update adds a new dependency (this will always be called out explicitly). A logic-only fix to an existing script never requires reinstalling anything.

12. Quick Reference Card

Keep this page handy — everything you need at a glance.

Browser Extension

Action	How
Install	chrome://extensions → Developer mode → Load unpacked
Trigger	Select text → right-click → AI Rewrite → pick a mode
Update key	Click extension icon → paste new key → Save

Desktop App (Windows)

Hotkey	Action
Ctrl+Alt+R	Fix Grammar & Spelling
Ctrl+Alt+I	Improve Writing
Ctrl+Alt+F	Make Formal
Ctrl+Alt+C	Make Casual
Ctrl+Alt+S	Make Shorter

Git Commit Tool

```
git add <files>
ai-commit
  [Enter] = commit    [e] = edit    [r] = regenerate    [q] = cancel
```